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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

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MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telcon with Helmut Kohl, Chancellor of
Germany on September 28, 1992

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Helmut Kohl, Chancellor
Interpreter: Gisala Marcuse
Notetaker: Tony Wayne

DATE, TIME September 28, 1992, 1:32 - 1:39pm EST
Air Force One

Chancellor Kohl: Hello, hello. (U)

The President: Helmut. How are you? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Hello George. It's good to hear your voice.
I'm ok. Is the campaign in full swing? (U)

The President: Yes, we're on an airplane right now going from
Missouri to Texas. We're going all the time now. How are you
doing? I've been thinking of you. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Alright. No serious problems. Just the
problem of a country where people take time getting used to
everyday problems. The German people are similar to the
Americans, they want to keep as much for themselves as they can
and don't want to give much away to others. (U)

The President: I think you're right that we face many of the
same problems. They keep getting on me for the economy. I keep
telling them the economy isn't so bad. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Yes, that's right. Thanks for your letter. I
talked to Jacques Delors today so that once your people come over
we can have another go on GATT. (U)

The President: That's great. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: My intention is to try to make my colleagues at
the special EC summit realize they should take one step further
on the Round. I'm not sure if I will be successful, but that's
what we agreed at Munich, and I want it to happen. If there is
more news I will give you a call. (U)

The President: Thanks. I haven't heard back from Delors on our
offer to send Carla Hills and Ed Madigan to Brussels for talks.

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I fully share your objective of trying for a U.S.-EC breakthrough in the next few weeks. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: I talked to him and tried to make sure he would inform Washington. I also tried to prepare the ground work as far as the French government is concerned. I'm concerned that it will be far from easy for them. The government there has serious problems. I'll try to do everything I can to make it possible for them to come along. I can't promise success, but will try my best. (P)

The President: One more question, Helmut. Do you think the referendum on Maastricht made it more or less difficult for Mitterrand to move on GATT? (U)

Chancellor Kohl: That's a question of judgement. If I were him I'd say it makes things easier because I'm convinced that if we'd finished GATT by June, it would have made the Maastricht referendum easier. But that's a judgement call. I will do my best to explain my view to him. (P)

The President: Thanks for the call, and thanks for helping with GATT. Let me know if there is anything we can do. We really need to get it finished. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Well George, I'm going to try. I will contact you by the end of next week if I have any news. Please give my regards to Barbara. And, I'll keep my fingers crossed. (U)

The President: Please do that. We're still behind in the polls, but we'll catch up with this guy. (U)

Chancellor Kohl: Best Luck. (U)

The President: Thanks. (U)

-- End of Conversation --

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